

KOI-KOI

The most widely played Hanafuda game. Two players compete over 12 rounds (one per month). Each round, players match cards from their hand to the table by suit, building a captured pile. When a player completes a scoring pattern (yaku), they choose: declare a win and collect points, or say **"Koi-Koi"** (「こいこい」, "come on") to continue playing for a higher score — at the cost of losing the bonus if the opponent scores first.

{{svg:koi-koi-board.svg "Koi-Koi – table layout"}}

SETUP

Shuffle the 48-card deck. Deal:

- ♦ 8 cards face-down to each player (hand)
- ♦ 8 cards face-up to the centre (field/table)
- ♦ Remaining 24 cards face-down as the draw pile

If either player is dealt a dealt yaku (Teshi or Kuttsuki, see below), they may declare it immediately for an automatic win.

TURN STRUCTURE

Players alternate. On your turn:

Play from hand: choose one card from your hand and place it face-up.

- ♦ If it matches a field card by suit (month), take both and add to your capture pile.
- 1 ♦ If two field cards match, you choose which to capture; if three match, you capture all three.
- ♦ If no match, the card remains in the field.

Draw from pile: flip the top card of the draw pile.

- 5 ♦ Apply the same matching rules.
- ♦ If it matches a field card, capture it. If not, it stays in the field.

Check for yaku: if your captures now complete one or more yaku, you must choose:

- 8 ♦ **Declare win:** the round ends; you score your yaku points.
- ♦ **Say Koi-Koi:** play continues. If you later complete additional yaku, your total score grows.

If you said Koi-Koi and the opponent completes a yaku before the round ends, the opponent scores **double** for that round.

A round also ends when both players exhaust their hands and the draw pile. If neither player declared a win, the round is a draw (no points scored).

YAKU (SCORING PATTERNS)

BRIGHT YAKU

YAKU	CARDS REQUIRED	POINTS
Goko ・ (Five Brights)	All 5 Brights	10
Shiko ・ (Four Brights)	Any 4 Brights, excluding Rain Man	8
Ame-Shiko ・ (Rainy Four Brights)	Any 4 Brights, including Rain Man	7
Sanko ・ (Three Brights)	Any 3 Brights, excluding Rain Man	5

VIEWING YAKU

YAKU	CARDS REQUIRED	POINTS
Tsukimi-de-Ippatsu ・ 月見 (Moon Viewing)	Full Moon (Aug) + Sake Cup (Sep)	5
Hanami-de-Ippatsu ・ 花見 (Blossom Viewing)	Cherry Curtain (Mar) + Sake Cup (Sep)	5

Note: Viewing yaku may be disabled by house rules in competitive play.

ANIMAL YAKU

YAKU	CARDS REQUIRED	POINTS
Ino-Shika-Chō ・ (Boar-Deer-Butterfly)	Boar (Jul) + Deer (Oct) + Butterflies (Jun)	5
Tane ・ (Animals)	Any 5 Animals	1 (+1 per additional)

RIBBON YAKU

YAKU	CARDS REQUIRED	POINTS
Akatan Aotan no Chofuku ・ 赤団扇 (Red Poetry)	All 3 Red Poetry + all 3 Blue ribbons	10
Akatan ・ (Red Poetry)	Pine + Plum + Cherry Poetry ribbons	5
Aotan ・ (Blue Ribbons)	Peony + Chrysanthemum + Maple ribbons	5
Tan ・ (Ribbons)	Any 5 Ribbons	1 (+1 per additional)

PLAIN YAKU

YAKU	CARDS REQUIRED	POINTS
Kasu ・ カス (Plains)	Any 10 Plains	1 (+1 per additional)

The Sake Cup (Sep-Animal) counts as both an Animal and a Plain in some house rules.

DEALT YAKU

Declared before play begins if dealt in the initial hand:

YAKU	CONDITION	POINTS
Teshi ・	Four cards of the same month dealt to one player	6 (or automatic win)
Kuttsuki ・ くつつぎ	Four pairs (8 cards, 4 matched suits) dealt to one player	6 (or automatic win)

If a dealt yaku occurs, the round is redealt or scored immediately per house rules.

SCORING AND ROUNDS

A standard game is **12 rounds**, one for each month. The player who dealt first in round 1 switches each round, or the previous round's winner deals.

If you declared Koi-Koi and won the round, your score is **doubled**.

If you said Koi-Koi and the opponent wins the round, the opponent's score is doubled.

A target score (e.g. 50 or 100 points over 12 rounds) determines the match winner, or simply the highest total after 12 rounds.

ATTRIBUTION

Koi-Koi ・ こいこい. Traditional Japanese card game. Rules in the public domain. Primary source: Wikipedia (*Koi-Koi*); secondary: Pagat.com (*Hanafuda*).